



PATH 20

Custom project setups

They want Claude Projects or Custom GPTs configured, not a lecture.

34 minute read · 7,538 words

Who this is for

Someone drowning in a blank project who will pay for a working one. You have already made a project you actually reuse.

Time to first

3–10 days

Tools

First sale

One setup a stranger can use without you in the room.

Cash window

\$97–\$297 per setup

Leave this alone

Claude Projects or Custom GPTs, a five-minute walkthrough recording, a \$197 button.

Selling access to a model you do not own. Keeping the project in your account so they have to stay.

What they actually buy

They buy instructions, files, and three starter chats that already work. You intake their actual job. You install it in an account they own. You test it. You record a five-minute walkthrough. You leave. They never need your login.

You are not reselling Claude. You are not reselling ChatGPT. You are selling configuration. Say that out loud so nobody is confused, including you. If your business requires them to keep using a project inside your account, you have built a hostage, not a product.

A blank project is a blinking cursor with extra steps. A configured one knows the job, the tone, the files it may use, and the three first prompts that produce something they recognize. The buyer should be able to open it on Thursday night and get a usable draft without writing a system prompt from scratch.

What this is not

It is not a course on prompt engineering. It is not a second brain with forty folders they will never open. It is not you wrapping someone else's model in a thin login screen and charging rent. Anthropic and OpenAI already sell the model. You sell the setup.

It is not a monthly "I host this for you." It is not training their whole staff. It is not connecting ten tools. If they want pipes into email, that is path 19, quoted separately. If they want you to run the job every week, that is a productized service, different number.

It is not a \$20 prompt they have to paste every time. A prompt they paste is not a project. Instructions plus files plus three working threads is a small appliance. Price the appliance.

Why this works now

The tools shipped a blank box and called it a product. People paid for the subscription, opened a project, and stared. They have watched a YouTube video. They have not configured the thing

for the job they actually do on Thursday. That gap is the \$197 setup.

You do not need a following. You need five people who already pay for the model and have said some version of "I never know what to put in the custom instructions." Cold strangers who will not pay for Claude will not pay you fairly either. You are not also selling them the model.

The work is short on purpose. Twenty minutes of intake. Instructions they can read. Three starters. Five minutes on video. A seven-day tweak window. Then you leave. The shortness is what makes it a product instead of a consulting engagement wearing a GPT.

Three anti-patterns

The first anti-pattern is hosting. They want it in your account so they do not have to pay for Claude. The answer is no. That is selling access to a model you do not own, plus a liability you cannot explain to a lawyer. Configure theirs. Leave.

The second is the second brain. You upload forty files "to be thorough." They never open the project again because it feels like a filing cabinet they did not ask for. Three starters they will run this week beat a knowledge base they will not maintain.

The third is mixing their confidential files into a sample you keep. Loading a client list into a project "to be helpful," or keeping copies "for the portfolio," is how you get a story you do not want. Follow their policy. When in doubt, do not upload. Paste per chat.

The deal you keep

You keep ownership in their account. You keep instructions they can edit without you. You keep three named starters that already return a draft a human would edit. You keep a five-minute walkthrough, not a webinar. You keep a seven-day tweak window that means instructions and starters, not a second job. You keep the right to delete their files from your machine on hand-off. That deal is the business.

Who this is for — and who should skip it

This path fits if you have already made a project or a custom GPT for yourself that you actually reuse. People around you have said some version of "I never know what to put in the custom instructions." You can sit in someone else's job for an hour without needing to become their employee.

You will hand the project over. Your name does not need to stay in the admin field. If you need their login after day eight, you did not hand off.

This fits you if

You can write instructions a tired person can read, not a wall of role-play.

You will hand the project over. Your name does not need to stay in the admin field.

You can record five minutes on a screen without turning it into a webinar.

You have five people who already pay for Claude or ChatGPT and stall on the blank box.

You can follow a data policy, including "do not upload that."

Skip this path if

Skip it if you planned to sell access to a model you do not own. Skip it if you want to keep their files in your account so they "have to stay." Skip it if you will load confidential client files into a model against their policy because it is easier. Skip it if you have never finished a project for your own job — do that first, then sell the shape.

Skip it if you freeze at the idea of asking five people. The page and the five asks are the path. A sample nobody sees is a hobby.

Skip it if you wanted to bundle automations, staff training, and a hosted GPT into \$197. That is a week of work at a setup price. Split it or pick a different path.

The honest middle

If you have a project you open every week for your own job, that is the sample. Record five minutes. Put \$197 on a page. Ask five people who already pay for the model. You are not waiting to become a prompt engineer. You are waiting to install the shape in an account that is not yours.

If you have only played with custom instructions once, configure one for a job you know this week. Fake files. Three starters. Then sell that job, not twelve industries.

Skills and time

You need one evening for the sample and the recording, one evening for the page, and five asks. Delivery is often one sitting plus the recording: intake, install in their account while they click, test a starter, send the walkthrough. The seven-day tweak window is one small change, not a redesign.

Writing skill here is short, editable instructions. If your natural mode is a 2,000-word role-play, this path will feel like cutting. That cut is the product. They should be able to change one line without breaking the rest.

Two-minute self-test

Answer these out loud. If two are blank, skip this path this month.

Name one job you have already configured a project for, that you still open.

Name five people who already pay for the model and stall on instructions.

Say, in one breath, that they own it and you do not keep a login.

Say what you will refuse to upload.

Record, in your head, the five minutes: open, starter, add a file, tweak one line, who owns it.

If all five have answers, build the sample today. If you cannot say they own it, you are about to build a hostage.

The offer, named in one sentence

Fill this and put it on the page: "I configure the [Claude Project or Custom GPT] for [named job]. You own it. Walkthrough included. \$[price]."

Jules uses: "I configure the project for your job. You own it. Walkthrough included. \$197." Keep it. The number can move inside \$97–\$297. The ownership cannot. If you need "and" to name the

job, you have two setups. Sell one.

Five sentences you can copy

I configure a Claude Project for solo bookkeepers who write collection and scheduling emails. You own it. Three starter chats. Five-minute walkthrough. \$197.

I configure a Custom GPT for one-person realtors who write listing descriptions from MLS notes. You own it. Walkthrough included. \$197.

I configure a Claude Project for a shop owner who drafts weekly Google posts from photos they already have. You own it. \$197.

I configure a Custom GPT for a solo accountant's month-end client questions, with a do-not-invent-a-balance rule. You own it. \$197.

I configure a Claude Project for two related jobs — listing draft and email follow-up — still in one project, picky tone, \$297.

Write yours with a job they will run this week. Do not write "a second brain for founders." That is a filing cabinet.

What they get

A 20-minute intake: the jobs, the files they are allowed to add, the tone.

Custom instructions they can read and edit.

Up to a small set of files they provide and approve.

Three starter threads that already return a decent first draft.

A five-minute walkthrough recording.

One tweak window of seven days. Tweak means instructions and starters, not a second job.

The project in their account. You leave.

What they do not get

Your Claude login. A monthly "I host this for you." Training their whole staff. Building a forty-file knowledge base they will not maintain. Connecting ten tools. Unlimited instruction rewrites.

A guarantee that the model will never change. If they want pipes into email, that is path

19, quoted separately. If they want you to run the emails each week, that is a service, different number.

They also do not get you as owner. Viewer for seven days if it helps them sleep. Then you leave.

Packaging

One job. One price on a button. \$197 default. What they must provide: the job, three tone samples, files they are allowed to upload, any data policy. What they own: the project. Stripe or Stan. Buy the button yourself from a second email so you know the confirmation works even if the "product" is a scheduled setup, not a zip.

Do not catalog twelve industries on the page. Do not add a membership around a setup you have done once. Do not throw automations into the \$197 so you work a week for a setup price.

What done looks like

Done is a setup a stranger can use without you. They open their own project. They click starter one. They get a draft they could send after a human edit. They know how to add a file and how to tweak a line of instructions because the walkthrough showed both.

Done is not pretty instructions in your account. Done is not a 40-minute training. Done is use-without-you, in their login, with your access removed.

The fairness test

Log out. Have them log in. Watch them run starter two without you typing. If they cannot, the walkthrough failed or the starters are cute instead of useful. Fix it inside the tweak window.

Fairness also means they can edit a line without breaking the rest. Instructions they are afraid to touch are a brochure. Fairness means files they consider confidential followed their policy, not your curiosity. Fairness means you are not the owner on day eight.

Technical done

Project created in their account. They clicked the buttons.

Instructions they can read and edit. Role, inputs, output shape, missing-info rule, do-not-invent rule.

Only approved files, dated, small.

Three named starter threads that already work.

They ran a starter without you typing.

Five-minute walkthrough delivered.

Seven-day tweak window in writing.

Your access removed. Their files deleted from your machine.

Not done yet

The project lives in your account "until they get set up."

Starter one needs a paragraph of extra prompting.

Instructions are a 2,000-word role-play.

You uploaded a client list they whispered about.

They have not run a starter without you.

Walkthrough is twelve minutes because you built too much.

You kept a copy of their phrases "for the portfolio."

They asked for a second job and you started it inside the \$197.

You are still admin after day eight.

If any of those are true, you do not call it handed off. You finish the install in their account or you stop and refund. There is no "I'll host it for now."

Pricing

The cash window is \$97–\$297 per setup. Jules charges \$197. That is the default button. Put it on the page. Do not hide it behind "DM me for a custom GPT."

Ranges

\$97 if you need the first case and the job is one you could configure in an hour. Once.

\$197 for a standard job: intake, instructions, three starters, five-minute walkthrough, one tweak window. Copy Jules.

\$297 if they have several file types, a tone that is actually picky, or two related jobs in one project (for example "listing draft" and "email follow-up") still inside one setup.

Do not charge \$20. That is a prompt, not a configuration. Do not charge \$1,000 unless you are also doing automations and a staff workshop, which is a different quote with a different name. Do not charge \$19/month for access to a GPT in your account. That is the leave-this-alone line.

When to raise

After five setups at \$197, if you are turning work away or the jobs got pickier. Move some work to \$297. Stay at \$197 for the clean one-job install you can now do in a sitting. Raise because the file types and tone got heavier, not because you added a membership.

If you charged \$97 once for a case, the next one is \$197. No story.

Refunds in one sentence

If they cannot run a starter in their own account without you, you refund. You do not refund because they dislike a draft the model wrote after they used it; you tweak instructions inside seven days.

Never charge for these

Never charge to host the model. Never charge rent on your login. Never charge for a forty-file dump they will not maintain, as if volume were quality. Never charge extra for the walkthrough. The walkthrough is the product. Never bundle path 19 automations into the \$197. Never charge \$20 so you can be sloppy.

Worked dollars

Jules's first paid setup: \$197 in, twenty minutes of intake, one screen-share install in Mara's account, a five-minute recording Jules already had, one three-line tweak in the window. That is

a sitting plus a recording. Five of those in a month is \$985 around a job. Three at \$297 because the tone was picky is \$891 with more grinding. Worked dollars go up when you stop hosting, stop overbuilding, and press \$197 instead of \$97 after the first case.

The first 72 hours

You do not need a catalog. You need a sample for a job you know, a \$197 button, and five asks.

Day 1 morning: a sample for a job you know

Build a sample project as if you were the client. Pick a job you have done: weekly posts, listing copy, invoice reminders, a study plan, follow-up emails. Write instructions in plain language. Role, inputs, output shape, what to ask if information is missing, what never to invent. Add one sample file you are allowed to use — fake names. Create three starter chats that already work. Name them in human language: "14-day reminder," not "prompt 1."

Day 1 afternoon: record five minutes

Open, pick a starter, add a file, change one instruction line, say who owns it. Do not record forty minutes. If you need twelve, you built too much. Cut a starter or a file until five minutes tells the whole story. This recording is the sales asset and, later, most of the hand-off.

Day 1 night: nothing else

Do not design a logo. Do not outline a course. The sample and the five minutes are the day's work. Go to bed with a project you would actually reuse.

Day 2: the \$197 button

One page. Sentence at the top. What they get. What they must provide (job, tone samples, files they are allowed to upload). What they own. Stripe or Stan at \$197. Buy it yourself from a second email so you know the confirmation works even if the "product" is a scheduled setup, not a zip.

Write the intake questions on the same page or in a form: the job (one primary), three examples of a tone they like, files they are allowed to add, any policy about data. "Do not send

confidential files you would not want in the model."

Day 3: five asks

Ask five people who complained about custom instructions. Direct messages, not a launch. "I configure the project for your job. You own it. Walkthrough included. \$197. If you want one, I'll send the intake." Do not explain five other services. Hand off so they never need your login.

If someone says they do not pay for Claude, do not argue. If someone wants you to "just write the emails each week," that is a service, different number. If someone says yes, schedule the install after they can log in. You do not sell them your account.

The path, step by step

Do these in order. Installing in your account "for now" is how you never leave. Uploading files they did not approve is how you get a story you do not want.

Pick the platform they already pay for. Claude Project or Custom GPT, not both, not a new app you invented. If they use both, pick the one for this job. Do not configure two for \$197. If they do not have a paid account, they need one. Send the signup link. Schedule the setup after they can log in.

Intake: the jobs (one primary), the files they are allowed to add, the tone in three samples they like, and any policy about data. Write it down. If they cannot name a job, sell them a cheaper pack instead. A 20-minute call or a clear form. Live is faster for hand-off. Jules uses twenty minutes live plus the recording.

Create the project in their account, or create it in yours only as a draft and copy the text over while they watch. They click the buttons. They own it. Screen share. You dictate, they paste. This is slower than you doing it in your login, and that slowness is the point.

Write instructions they can read. Role, inputs, output shape, what to ask if information is missing, what never to invent. Short. Under a page. They should be able to edit a line without breaking the rest. If you need four pages, you are writing a playbook and calling it a project.

Add only the files they approved. Do not scrape their Drive. Do not upload a client list they whispered about. Dated. Small. When in doubt, do not upload. Paste per chat. Write that in the intake.

Build three starter threads that already work: the three jobs they will actually open this week. Name the threads in human language. Not edge cases. Not "tell me about yourself." If starter one needs a paragraph of extra prompting, you failed the configuration.

Test with a real example they provided, or a fake one if policy says so. If the output is fluff, cut the instructions, do not add a fourth file. Leave something out on purpose once so you can see the missing-info rule fire. That is a quality check, not a trick.

Record a five-minute walkthrough: where it lives, how to run a starter, how to add a file, how to tweak one instruction, who owns it. Show the off-ramp: how they edit you out of the instructions later. If you already recorded the sample, add a 40-second ending: "this is yours, I'm not in the account."

Hand off. Confirm they can run it without you. Start the seven-day tweak window in writing. You may stay as invited viewer for seven days. You are not the owner.

One tweak, if they ask. Instruction and starter fixes. Not a redesign. Not a second project. Not "also build my content engine." Write that down.

Leave their account. Delete any copies of their files that landed on your machine. If you need their login after day eight, you did not hand off. Go back and finish.

After the first stranger uses it without you, write the intake as a form so job two is faster. Do not add a membership around a setup you have done once. The form is five fields, not a quiz.

After five setups, look at the log. If they never opened it two weeks later, you overbuilt or you sold to someone who wanted a course. If you are stuck at \$97, press \$197 and live with fewer yeses.

If three clients needed the same shape, that generic version (no client files) can become a skill pack, sold as a file. Different product. Do not mix a custom setup with a shared GPT you rent out.

Keep a one-line log: date, job, fee, they ran a starter without you Y/N, tweak was actually a second job Y/N, still opening it two weeks later. Ask once. Do not babysit.

Stop if you are still hosting, still admin, or still holding their files. Fix ownership this week. The path is configuration, not tenancy.

A worked example: Jules at \$197

Jules keeps hearing the same sentence from independent bookkeepers: "I opened a Claude Project and then I just... stared at it." Jules is not selling bookkeeping. Jules is selling a configured project for client follow-up emails.

Monday: the sample

Jules makes a project titled "Follow-up emails — sample." Instructions: you write collection and scheduling emails for a solo bookkeeper; you never invent a balance; you ask for the amount if it is missing; tone is plain, no "just circling back" stacks; max eight sentences. One sample file: a fake aged-receivables list with made-up names. Three starters: (1) 14-day reminder, (2) 30-day firmer note, (3) scheduling next month's close. Jules records five minutes. The \$197 button goes on a page Tuesday.

Tuesday: the button, then five asks

Jules buys the page from a second email. Confirmation arrives. Jules messages five bookkeepers who already complained. Two ignore. One says "I don't pay for Claude." Jules does not argue. One wants Jules to "just write the emails each week." That is a service, path 7, different number. One says yes: Mara, two days a week in her own books, already pays for Claude, hates the blank project.

Wednesday: intake, twenty minutes

Jobs: follow-up on unpaid invoices, and a short "what I need from you for month-end" note. Files Mara is allowed to add: her template phrases, not her real client spreadsheet. Policy: no client names in the project until Mara pastes them per chat. Tone: Mara forwards three emails she was proud of. Jules writes instructions from those, not from a persona Jules invented.

Wednesday, still: install in Mara's account

Screen share. Mara creates the project. Jules dictates, Mara pastes. Three starter chats Jules types while Mara watches, then Mara re-runs starter one on a fake invoice. It asks for the amount because Jules left it out on purpose. That is the quality check. Walkthrough recording is the same five minutes Jules already had, plus a 40-second ending: "this is yours, I'm not in the account."

Mara pays \$197. Tweak window through the next Wednesday.

The mistake, and the recovery

Jules almost makes the first real mistake after the call. Mara's three proud emails are sitting in Jules's downloads folder, and Jules's hand wants to keep them "as a tone sample for the next bookkeeper." That is their voice, not a generic pack. Jules deletes the folder the same afternoon. The fake receivables list stays in Jules's sample project. Mara's phrases do not. If Jules had kept them, the first stranger sale would have been built on a file Jules did not own.

Mara asks, inside the window, to soften starter two. Jules changes three lines. That is a tweak. Mara also asks whether Jules can "stay as admin so I don't break it." Jules says no. Viewer until next Wednesday. Then Jules leaves. Ownership is the product.

The first stranger sale

Mara mentions Jules in a bookkeeper group chat, without sharing the project. A stranger, Len, already pays for Claude, writes the same follow-ups, and buys the \$197 button on a Thursday. Intake is a form Jules wrote after Mara. Install is Friday screen share. Len runs starter two without Jules typing. \$197. No discount. Jules is not in the account on Monday. That is the first stranger sale: a working project in someone else's login, used without Jules in the room.

Jules does not keep a copy "for the portfolio" with Len's phrases in it. Jules shows the fake receivables list when people ask for a case.

Copy you can actually send

Use these. Swap the job. Do not add a lecture. Do not add "access my GPT."

Post

I configure the project for your job. You own it. Three starter chats that already work, and a five-minute walkthrough. \$197. I don't keep a login.

DM

You said you never know what to put in the custom instructions. I'll set up the project in your account for [job], with three starter chats that already work, and a five-minute walkthrough. \$197. You own it. I don't keep a login.

Page hero

A working Claude Project (or Custom GPT) for one job. Not a lecture. Not my account. \$197.

Checkout line

\$197. Intake, instructions you can edit, up to a small set of files you approve, three named starters, five-minute walkthrough, seven days for one tweak. You own the project. You need your own Claude or ChatGPT subscription. I am not selling the model.

Email 1, the ask

Subject: I'll configure the project — \$197

You said you never know what to put in the custom instructions. I'll set up the project in your account for [job], with three starter chats that already work, and a five-minute walkthrough. \$197. You own it. If you want one, reply with the job, three tone samples, and any files you are allowed to upload. Do not send confidential files you would not want in the model.

Email 2, intake booked

Subject: Setup on [date] — you will click the buttons

We will use your account. You create the project. I dictate, you paste. Bring: the job, three examples of a tone you like, files you are allowed to add. I will not take ownership. Walkthrough is five minutes. Tweak window is seven days after hand-off.

Email 3, hand-off

Subject: It's in your account — tweak window until [date]

It's in your account. Starters are named. Walkthrough is here: [link]. You have seven days for one tweak on instructions or starters. After that, a new job is a new setup. I am not in the account. Delete any files I should not have; I have deleted copies on my machine.

Refund email

Subject: Refund for [job] setup

You cannot run a starter in your account without me. I am refunding the \$197. I have removed any access I had. You do not need to reply.

What you do not write

"Access my GPT, \$19/month." "I'll host your brain." "Upload everything you have." Those are the leave-this-alone line and a policy problem.

Week-by-week if you have a job

You can do this around a job if you protect two evenings and one 45-minute screen share. The goal of the first month is three setups a stranger can use without you.

Week 1

Day 1: sample project for a job you know, tested, plus the five-minute walkthrough. Fake files only.

Day 2: page with a \$197 button. Test-buy from a second email. Intake questions on the page.

Day 3: three asks to people who already pay for the model.

Day 4: two more asks. Do not design a catalog of twelve industries.

Day 5: if a yes arrives, schedule intake after they can log in. Do not start in your account.

Day 6–7: deliver the first paid setup if the calendar says so, or rest. Do not start a "hosted GPT" idea because someone asked.

Week 2

Day 8–9: install in their account. They click. They run a starter without you typing. Walkthrough sent. Tweak window in writing.

Day 10: delete their files from your machine. Write the intake as a form.

Day 11–14: one tweak if they ask. Viewer access ends. You leave. Two more asks if you have no second buyer.

Week 3

Two more asks, or a second paid setup at \$197. Same ownership rules. If nobody buys, the job is too vague or you asked strangers who do not already pay for the model. Sell to people who already have the subscription. You are not also selling them Claude.

Week 4

Third setup or stop. Log fees, "ran without you," tweaks that were actually a second job. If three clients needed the same shape, note it for a later skill pack with generic files. Do not mix that pack with this custom setup. Ask once whether they still open the project. If they never opened it, you overbuilt or you sold a course to a person who wanted a lecture.

The quality bar

The bar is use-without-you. Pretty instructions that nobody runs are a brochure. Volume of knowledge files is not quality. Jules's bookkeeper project used phrases, not a dump of five years

of returns.

Below the bar

Project in your account.

2,000-word role-play they are afraid to edit.

Starters that only work if you are typing.

A 40-minute "training" instead of a five-minute walkthrough.

Confidential files they did not approve.

Forty folders they will never open.

Selling access to Claude as if you were the vendor.

Automations bundled into the \$197.

Copies of their files on your machine after hand-off.

You still admin after day eight.

Above the bar

Their account. They clicked.

Instructions under a page: role, inputs, output, missing-info, do-not-invent.

Three named starters that produce a draft a human would edit.

Approved files only, small, dated.

Five-minute walkthrough that shows ownership and how to edit you out.

They run a starter without you typing.

Seven-day tweak, then closed.

Your access gone. Their files gone from your machine.

Five tests before you leave

The log-out test. You are not in the room. They run starter two.

The edit test. They change one instruction line and it still works.

The missing-info test. You leave a number out. It asks. It does not invent.

The file test. Nothing in the project that they did not approve.

The five-minute test. The walkthrough is five minutes. If you need twelve, you built too much.

If you fail one test, you are not handed off. You fix it inside the sitting or inside the tweak window. You do not "stay as admin until they are comfortable." Comfort is them clicking, not you owning.

What to count

Count a short list. File counts are vanity. Jules used phrases, not a dump.

Week 1

Sample project tested: yes or no.

Five-minute walkthrough recorded: yes or no.

\$197 button test-bought: yes or no.

Asks sent: target 5.

Paid setups: target 1. A sample in your account is not a sale.

Day 30

Setups handed off: target 3.

They ran a starter without you: yes or no. That is the first-sale definition.

Tweak requests that are actually a second job. Those mean intake was soft.

Time from intake to hand-off. Target: inside a week, often one sitting plus the recording.

Average fee. If you are stuck at \$97 after five, press \$197 and live with fewer yeses.

Your access removed: yes or no.

Day 90

How many still open the project two weeks later — ask once. If they never opened it, you overbuilt or you sold a course.

Stranger sales: at least 1.

Fee at \$197 or \$297, not \$97.

Zero hosted GPTs.

Intake lives in a form.

One note about a generic skill pack, if three clients needed the same shape. Not built yet unless the custom work is boring in a good way.

If day 90 is empty, you asked people who do not pay for the model, or you never sent the five asks. Stop adding files to the sample. Send the sentence.

Ignore

How many knowledge files you uploaded. How long the instructions are past one page. Time spent naming a "studio." Compliments that are not a starter they ran.

One-line spreadsheet

Date | job in five words | fee | they ran starter without you Y/N | tweak was second job Y/N | access removed Y/N | still opening it two weeks later Y/N

That is the whole system.

Objections you will hear — including your own

Reply once. Do not hold a prompt-engineering seminar in the thread.

"They could watch a YouTube video."

They could. They have not. You are selling a configured job in their account in a week, not a lecture.

"Isn't this just writing a prompt?"

A prompt they have to paste every time is not a project. Instructions plus files plus three working threads is a small appliance. Price the appliance.

"They want it in my account so they don't have to pay for Claude."

No. That is selling access to a model you do not own. They need their own subscription. You configure it. If they will not pay the model, they will not pay you fairly either.

"What about confidential files?"

Follow their policy. When in doubt, do not upload. Paste per chat. Write that in the intake. Loading their client list into a project "to be helpful" is how you get a story you do not want.

"Can I productize one project and sell access to many buyers?"

That is a skill pack (path 2), with generic files, not their confidential ones. Different product. Do not mix a custom setup with a shared GPT you rent out.

"Is \$197 too low?"

It is a setup, not a month of service. If they want weekly-run work, sell path 7. If the setup is truly two jobs and picky files, \$297. Do not raise to \$1,000 for instructions.

"Can I do this over email only?"

Yes, if they write a clear intake. Live screen share is faster for hand-off. Jules uses twenty minutes live plus the recording. Default: live for job one.

"They want me to stay as admin."

No. Viewer for seven days if it helps them sleep. Then you leave. Ownership is the product. If they are afraid to click, the walkthrough failed. Fix the walkthrough, do not take the keys.

"What if the model changes next month?"

You guarantee a working configuration at hand-off and one tweak week. After that, they own the maintenance, or they buy another setup. You do not guarantee output quality forever.

"I don't have five people who pay for Claude."

Then this is not your first path this month. Sell a playbook or a service to people you already know, then offer setups to the ones who already have the subscription.

What this feeds — and what feeds it

Hand off. The best compliment is a week of silence because they are using it.

What feeds a \$197 setup

People who already pay for Claude or ChatGPT and stall on the blank project. Buyers of a skill pack who want it installed. Service clients who keep asking you to "just set up the GPT." Your own sample and walkthrough. A brief (path 18) whose next step was "configure the tool," quoted separately.

People who do not pay for the model are not feedstock. You are not the vendor.

What a setup feeds

Skill packs, if three clients needed the same shape. Generic version, no client files, sold as a file.

Automations, if they then want the project to draft from a form. New quote. Path 19.

A productized service, if they want you to run the job, not own the tool.

Another \$197 setup for a second job, after the first is in their account and used.

Not a hosted model business. That is the thing you leave alone.

What not to feed

Do not feed a membership that is actually access to your account. Do not feed a staff workshop into the \$197. Do not use their files as the next sample. Do not turn the seven-day tweak window into a weekly run of the job.

Mistakes that kill this path

Keeping the project in your account. Loading their confidential files into a model against their policy. Overbuilding a second brain they will never open. Those three still kill it. The rest kill it more slowly.

Ten mistakes and the recovery this week

Keeping the project in your account. Recovery: copy the text into theirs on a screen share today. Remove yourself. If they will not pay for the model, refund and stop.

Loading confidential files they did not approve. Recovery: delete from the project and from your machine today. Tell them. Paste-per-chat from now on.

Overbuilding a second brain. Recovery: cut to three starters and the files they will use this week. Archive the rest. Re-record five minutes.

Writing instructions they are afraid to edit. Recovery: cut to under a page. Role, inputs, output, missing-info, do-not-invent. Have them change one line with you watching.

Starters that only work if you are typing. Recovery: log out. Watch them run starter two. Rewrite the starter until they can.

A 40-minute "training" instead of a five-minute walkthrough. Recovery: record five minutes tonight. Send that. Do not schedule a webinar.

Selling access to Claude as if you were the vendor. Recovery: take the page down. Refund anyone in your account. Configure theirs or stop.

Bundling automations into the \$197. Recovery: finish the setup only. Quote path 19 separately. Do not keep building pipes inside this fee.

Keeping copies of their files "for examples." Recovery: delete them today. Use your fake sample for the portfolio.

Staying admin after day eight because they asked. Recovery: drop to viewer, then leave. Fix the walkthrough if they are scared. Do not take the keys.

Asking people who do not pay for the model. Recovery: rewrite the five names. Only subscribers. You are not selling Claude.

Discounting to \$20 because it "felt like a prompt." Recovery: next button is \$197. A prompt they paste is not this product.

If you catch yourself in any of these, the recovery is this week. Ownership and files do not wait until you "have a process."

Tools — only what you need

Claude Projects or Custom GPTs. One. The five-minute walkthrough: QuickTime, Loom, or your phone pointed at the screen, as long as they can hear you and see the clicks. Configure the tool they already open.

Exact stack

Claude Projects or Custom GPTs, whichever they already pay for.

A page with a \$197 button (Stan, Stripe Payment Link, Gumroad — one).

An intake form: job, tone samples, files allowed, policy notes.

Stripe or Stan. Test-buy from a second email.

A calendar slot of 45 minutes if you do intake live, or the form if they write clearly.

Screen share for the install (their tool, not yours).

A place to send the five-minute recording they own.

Setup order

Sample project for a job you know, tested.

Five-minute walkthrough.

\$197 button, test-confirmed.

Intake questions written.

Five asks.

Live install in their account.

They run a starter.

Walkthrough sent, tweak window in writing.

Access removed, their files deleted from your machine.

What not to buy

Do not build a native app. Do not resell API access. Do not stand up a team workspace they do not need. Do not buy a "GPT store" plan that is actually you hosting. Do not add an automation platform inside this fee. Do not buy a course on prompt empires.

The \$0 path

A Claude or ChatGPT account you already pay for, used only to build the sample, never to host theirs. A Google Doc as the "page" with a payment link you already have. Loom free, or your phone. A Google Form for intake. The \$0 path is allowed for the first setup. It is not an excuse to host them in your login or to skip the walkthrough.

Checklist

- Sample project for a job you know, tested
- Fake files in the sample, no client data
- Five-minute walkthrough recorded
- \$197 button on a page, test-confirmed
- Five asks to people who already pay for the model
- Intake: job, tone, allowed files, data policy
- They have their own paid account before you start
- Project created in their account
- They click the buttons
- Instructions they can read and edit, under a page
- Missing-info rule and do-not-invent rule

Three named starter threads that already work

No confidential files they did not approve

They run a starter without you typing

Walkthrough delivered

Seven-day tweak window in writing

Tweak means instructions and starters, not a second job

Your access removed

Their files deleted from your machine

You said out loud: you are not reselling the model

No \$19/month access to your GPT

Automations quoted separately if they ask

One-line spreadsheet row filled

Viewer, if any, ends on day eight

Portfolio uses the fake sample only

FAQ

Claude Project or Custom GPT?

Whichever they already pay for and open. If they use both, pick the one for this job. Do not configure two for \$197. Default: their daily tool.

What if they do not have a paid account?

They need one. You do not sell them yours. Send the signup link. Schedule the setup after they can log in. Default: no install until they can click.

Can I do this over email only?

Yes, if they write a clear intake. Live screen share is faster for hand-off. Jules uses twenty minutes live plus the recording. Default: live for the first three jobs.

How long should instructions be?

Short enough they will edit them. Usually under a page. If you need four pages, you are writing a playbook (path 1) and calling it a project. Default: under a page.

What goes in the three starters?

The three jobs they will actually run this week. Not edge cases. Not "tell me about yourself." Named, boring, useful. Default: three jobs they named in intake.

Is \$197 too low?

It is a setup, not a month of service. If they want weekly-run work, sell path 7. If the setup is truly two jobs and picky files, \$297. Default: \$197 until five setups say otherwise.

What is the tweak window for?

Instruction and starter fixes. Not "also build my content engine." Write that down. Default: seven days, one tweak.

Can I show their project as a case study?

Only with permission, and never with their files. Show your sample instead. Jules shows the fake receivables list. Default: fake sample only.

Do I guarantee output quality forever?

No. Models change. You guarantee a working configuration at hand-off and one tweak week. After that, they own the maintenance, or they buy another setup. Default: no forever.

What if they ask me to stay as admin?

No. Viewer for seven days if it helps them sleep. Then you leave. Ownership is the product. Default: leave.

Can I keep a copy of the instructions I wrote?

The generic shape, yes. Their tone samples and files, no. Default: delete their materials from your machine on hand-off.

Should I configure both Claude and ChatGPT?

Not for \$197. One platform, the one they open. A second platform is a second setup at \$197 or a \$297 two-job quote, written. Default: one.

What if they want forty knowledge files?

No. Small set they will maintain. A second brain they will never open is a mistake, not a bonus. Default: only approved, small, dated files.

Can this replace a productized service?

No. This is configuration. Running the job every week is path 7. If they ask you to stay and write the emails, quote the service. Default: do not run the job inside the setup fee.

When do I turn this into a skill pack?

After three clients needed the same shape. Generic files. No confidential anything. Different page, different product. Default: not after one setup.